

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 90

By Boyd

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Melanie R. Bean for her honorable and astute service to the people of Tennessee as the 2024–2025 president of the Tennessee Association of Criminal Defense Lawyers.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy individual is Melanie R. Bean of Lebanon, who is the 2024–2025 president of the Tennessee Association of Criminal Defense Lawyers (TACDL); and

WHEREAS, the Tennessee Association of Criminal Defense Lawyers was formed and chartered in 1973, making it the oldest legal defense bar association in the State; TACDL provides education, training, and support to criminal defense lawyers and advocates for fair and effective criminal justice in the courts and wherever justice demands; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Bean entered the world of criminal defense in 1998 when she served as a law clerk for the Honorable Frank Lannom, whom she later joined in practice, and she has been a member of TACDL for over twenty years; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to leadership, she has served two times on the TACDL Board of Directors, a testament to her consistent devotion and the respect she has earned from her peers; and

WHEREAS, a former legislative committee chair, Ms. Bean has regularly represented TACDL in their legislative aims, including collaborating with legislators on policy development and providing testimony to various committees in the legislature; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Bean is equally active and influential outside of TACDL; she currently serves as an appointed member of the Domestic Violence State Coordinating Counsel and previously served as an appointed hearing committee member for the Tennessee Board of Professional Responsibility from 2011 to 2017; and

WHEREAS, thanks to her superlative work and skill, she has rightfully accrued several recognitions and honors, including the Workhouse Award and Rob W. Ritchie Award, both from TACDL, as well as the Distinguished Alumni Award from Cumberland University; and

WHEREAS, apart from her work as a partner of Lannom and Williams, PLLC, Ms. Bean helps to maintain her family's farm in Clay County on which she grew up; although she still maintains a great love for her roots in Clay County, she now resides in Lebanon, where she is a church member of The Bridge Fellowship; and

WHEREAS, her remarkable success in and outside of the courtroom stems from her dedication to safeguarding basic human dignity and to serving others with her legal talents and community involvement; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Bean has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity as an attorney and civic leader, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of members of the bar and bench and her community alike; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Melanie R. Bean for her meritorious service to the people of Tennessee as the 2024–2025 president of the Tennessee Association of Criminal Defense Lawyers and extend to her our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.